LEGION LETTER

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION
PARIS BRANCH

SEPTEMBER 2007

Chairman's Report

Since the Summer break your Committee has already met and a programme of social events is announced in this Newsletter. We trust you will have come back refreshed from your holidays.

You will recall in the May Newsletter the report on the visit in April to Dieppe and Bruneval. This sparked the interest of one of our members, Jean-Pierre Renouard, himself a former Résistant. He has been reading the autobiography of "Rémy", the code name of Colonel Gilbert Renault, one of whose missions was the reconnaissance of Bruneval village in advance of the Raid. Jean-Pierre's account of that daring mission is included in this Newsletter. We are very grateful to him, and I commend the article to you.

Colonel Oliver Warman is leading us on our next visit, to Ypres and Passchendaele on Saturday 27th and 28th October. If you are planning to come on this visit could you please return to me the Reply Slip at the foot of this page before 7th October please.

Roger Thorn

« We will remember them »

VISIT TO YPRES AND PASSCHENDAELE

Colonel Oliver Warman is leading us to Ypres and Passchendaele on 27th and 28th October. We plan to arrive in Ypres on the evening of Friday 26th in time to leave early on Saturday by coach around the sites of the battlefields on the Saturday. At 20h00 we have arranged for Paris Branch to be the guest organization to attend the moving Ceremony at the Menin Gate on the Saturday evening, and the Branch Standard will be paraded. This is followed by Dinner in Ypres. Those who wish to may attend the Service in Ypres Cathedral on the Sunday morning before the party breaks up. The final detail of the cost is still being negotiated with the different parties, but the total for two nights accommodation, coach hire and dinner is expected to be around 220 euros per head. If you wish to come please return the
Reply Slip below by post or e-mail by **7th October**. Details of cost and payment will follow.

YPRES VISIT REPLY SLIP (Reply by 7th October latest)

To: Roger Thorn
4, place du Marché,
78110 Le Vésinet
e-mail: roger.thorn@wanadoo.fr

From: .....
Contact telephone number: .....
e-mail: .....

I/ We wish to come on the Ypres visit. I shall need accomodation in:

Single bedroom (Yes/No): .....
Double bedroom (Yes/No): .....

SECRETARIES CORNER

Dear Members,

We on the Secretarial side of Legion Life hope that you are all feeling refreshed after the summer holiday season.

Your Committee are busy preparing the Autumn/Winter programme of events. We start with the Poppy Appeal Coffee Morning at the Ambassador's Residence with Lady Westmacott acting as our Hostess. You will note the Coffee Morning Flyer included with this newsletter. Please come along and support this event. We are always on the lookout for prizes for our Tombola, so, if you think you could donate a prize please contact Joan Hicks or bring the gift to the Coffee Morning.

We have a new Poppy Appeal Organiser in Joyce Gilhooley. Thank you Joyce for taking on this post, I know you will give it your best shot. Thanks must go to Anne Boit who is standing down due to work and family commitments. Anne did us proud with exceptional results and lots of hard work.

If you think you could be a Poppy Seller or know of an outlet where we might put a Poppy Box, please contact me, Janet Warby on 01 39 28 90 28 or Joyce Gilhooley on 01 43 21 57 20, both of us have answering machines so you can leave us a message if we are not available.

Our Service of Remembrance will be held at Notre Dame Cathedral on 11th November. The Service commences at 15h00. For those wishing to attend the Service please be seated no later than 14h40.

Our A.G.M., is scheduled for early December. The date is 10th December at 18h30.

The 1st October is the beginning of the Royal British Legion Financial Year. This means Subscriptions are due once again. We have kept our subs the same and a renewal form is included with this newsletter. You have until mid-December to pay your subs. This is a rule as laid down by the Royal Charter. We have to send back all cards not claimed by the end of January otherwise your Branch gets charged for the cards not paid for; this is a charge we cannot afford.

We will be holding our next Club Lunch on Thursday 11th October. Please book early to avoid disappointment, we are limiting our numbers to 24. The following months lunch will be held on Wednesday 21st November and the Christmas lunch and dinner will be held on Friday 14th December (lunch) and Tuesday 18th December (dinner). Please see the attached reply slips to reserve your place.

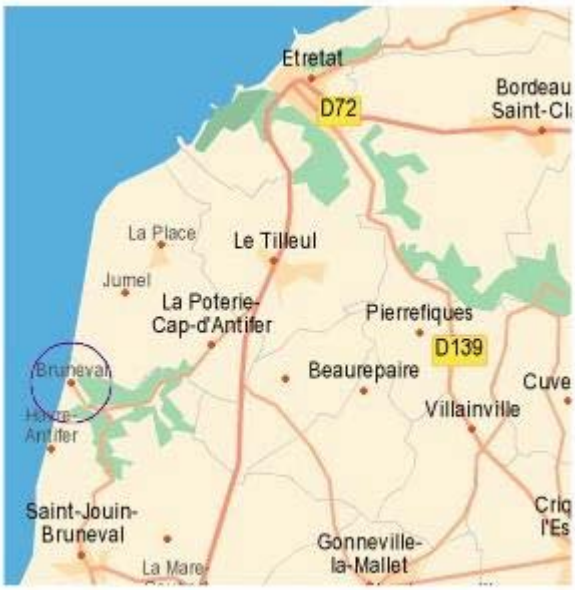
Best wishes to you all.

Janet Warby	Joan Hicks	Mark Yates
Hon. Secretary	Social Secretary	Membership Secretary

THE BRUNEVAL RADAR STATION

By Jean-Pierre Renouard

On 24th January 1942 the Free French Intelligence office in London sent a coded message to “Rémy”, the code name for Colonel Gilbert Renault, a Résistance leader in France, asking for all kinds of intelligence information on Bruneval village and its surroundings. No doubt they were following through a request from the S.O.E.



The coast of France from Dunkirk to the Spanish border was a *zone interdite*; Frenchmen who lived and worked there needed a special pass, an *Ausweis* from the German Command, which they had to carry at all times. They were the only ones authorized to enter those areas.

In his memoirs Rémy does not say how he obtained a pass or if he used a forged one. But he did go to Bruneval at the end of January 1942 to gather the intelligence requested. He was travelling with his assistant « Pol » and a garage owner from Le Havre called Charles Chauveau. The latter provided the transportation which was extremely scarce as no petrol was allocated to civilians. The three men piled into an old Simca with great difficulty. It was bitterly cold, with snow on the ground. Reaching Bruneval they went to the only hotel there, the Beauminet, and settled in the only available room. The hotel had been taken over by the Germans, who were quartered in all the other rooms, as well as in two summer houses between the village and the sea.

In a few days, thanks to the Beauminet people, particularly Mrs Paul Vanniet and to a cooperative middle-aged German sentry, they were able to collect the information requested, draw a detailed map of the area and take some photographs.

On 9th February 1942 Rémy sent the following coded message to the

Free French Intelligence office in London:

9-2-42. - De Raymond (code A) N° 84-1.- Affaire Theuville - Stop - Le chemin part d'une plage de galets de 22 mètres entre hautes falaises et va au village de La Poterie en passant par Bruneval - Stop - 1° plage et côte non minées. 2° deux mitrailleuses dans première maison près plage. 3° barbelés 10 mètres puis 110 mètres sur chemin, deux barbelés 10 mètres épaisseur. 4° il y aurait deux postes mitrailleuses sur falaises de part et d'autre. 5° 30 défenseurs sous ordre adjutant-chef remplacés toutes les trois semaines trente-cinq à quarante ans - Stop à suivre.
9-2-42.-De Raymond (code A) N° 82.- Aucun entraînement spécial - Stop - Cinq dans la maison du secondo ci-dessus; 25 travaillant le jour aux abris et blockhaus pour batteries du cap Antifer et couchant le soir au restaurant Beauminet, dernière maison sur la droite et à 500 mètres de la plage, juste avant route Saint-Jouin. 6° 60 hommes à La Poterie même classe que ceux du quinto logés dans école et mairie. 7° autant à Saint-Jouin. Aucune méfiance - Fin

It appears that his intelligence work was of some help to the British forces who later conducted the now famous night raid. I can visualize the three Résistance fellows having supper in the Beauminet restaurant, sitting among 25 German soldiers!

EARL HAIG POPPY APPEAL 2007

Lady Westmacott, wife of H.M. Ambassador

to France, has kindly accepted to host a

Coffee Morning in aid of the Poppy Appeal

which the ROYAL BRITISH LEGION,

PARIS BRANCH, organizes every year

for the benefit of the

EARL HAIG BENEVOLENT FUND

The Coffee Morning will take place at

THE AMBASSADOR'S RESIDENCE

39 rue du Faubourg St. Honoré

PARIS 8éme

THURSDAY 8th NOVEMBER, 2007

10.30 am - 12 noon

Please send your stamped addressed envelope to :
Miss Joan M. Hicks
6 rue des Petits Prés
78810 Feucherolles

An invitation card for presentation at the entrance will be sent to you. This event is free of charge. Donations Welcome. I.D. Cards or Passports required. Numbers limited. Date limit 31/10/07

Club Lunch – Thursday 11th October - € 12 - 12.15

Name .....

Address .....

.....

Please reserve for me ..... place(s)

I enclose a cheque for € ..... payable to Royal British Legion

---

Club Lunch – Wednesday 21st November - €12 - 12.15

Name .....

Address .....

.....

Please reserve for me ..... place(s)

I enclose a cheque for € ..... payable to Royal British Legion

---

Club Christmas Lunch – Friday 14th December price & time to be advised

Name .....

Address .....

.....

Plese reserve for me ..... place(s)

I enclose a cheque for € ..... payable to Royal British Legion

---

Club Christmas Dinner – Tuesday 18th December price & time to be advised

Name .....

Address .....

.....

Please reserve for me ..... place(s)

I enclose a cheque for € ..... payable to Royal British Legion

---

PLEASE SEND YOUR RESERVATIONS TO MISS J.M. HICKS
6 RUE DES PETITS PRES, 78810 FEUCHEROLLES. TEL 01 30 54 33 06
NOT LATER THAN THREE (3) DAYS BEFORE THE EVENT.

A word in your ear...

October, you will have noticed, is creeping inexorably up on us again. Memories of the holiday season fade and the temperatures, never very high this year, drop to new lows.

Long term members, finely tuned to seasonal change, some of you indeed, like me, rendered hypersensitive by encroaching seasonal arthritis and the like, know, as an autumnal shiver runs down your spine, that this means your annual subscription to the Royal British Legion Paris Branch is due - on 1st October to be exact.

More recent members - well, you will get used to it.

As I have pointed out in previous missives of a similar kind, HQ, in their wisdom, are encouraging earlier and earlier (or as they would put it, more and more prompt) payment of subscriptions. Thank you, in advance to all those of you who pay up in October. It makes life so much easier at this end.

In consolation, October also signals the start of the years activities, with coffee morning at the Embassy, our monthly lunches, and of course, on the horizon, our grand occasion of the year, Notre Dame on 11 November. Details elsewhere on this.

As some of you know I run the rblfrance.org website. An innovation which we promised last year and have now introduced is the possibility of getting the Paris Branch Newsletter online. Getting on for half our membership now have email and I would like to take this opportunity to remind you to let me have your email addresses if you have acquired one during the year. If the internet version of the Newsletter suits you, please let me know - by email - and I shall send you the link as and when new issues come out. If you prefer the real paper and ink version you will , of course, continue to receive it.

You can send any information to mfyates@gmail.com or to paris@rblfrance.org which is our official email address on the website which, can be consulted at http://www.rblfrance.org/ Don’t forget; you can check events etc. on the site.

Subscription forms are included with this newsletter. I look forward to hearing from you all soon.

Mark Yates
Membership secretary

Un mot à l'oreille…

Le mois d'octobre approche, vous l'avez sûrement remarqué, à grands pas. Les souvenirs des vacances s'effacent, et les températures, jamais très satisfaisantes cette année, descendent encore plus bas...

Nos membres de longue date - sensibles aux changements des saisons, certains même, comme moi, hypersensibles grâce aux symptômes d'arthrite saisonnier et d'autres rheumatismes - vous savez que tout ceci signale l'approche de la date de votre abonnement annuel à la Royal British Legion Paris Branch - le 1° octobre, pour être précis.

Nos membres de date plus récente - Eh bien, vous allez vous y habituer...

Comme je vous ai indiqué, dans d'autres missives précédentes, notre siège, dans sa sagesse, encourage que le règlement des abonnements se fasse de plus en plus tôt (ou, selon eux, de plus en plus promptement). Nous remercions d'avance tous ceux qui règleront pendant le mois d'octobre. Il est vrai que cela nous rend la vie tellement plus facile...

Comme savent certains parmi vous, je m'occupe également du site web rblfrance.org. Une innovation promise l'année dernière est maintenant réalisée ; vous pouvez recevoir votre "Newsletter" sous forme électronique. Près de la moitie de nos membres possèdent maintenant une adresse e-mail et il se peut que vous préfériez ce mode de livraison. Evidement, si vous préférez la version papier, il vous sera envoyé comme toujours.

Pour toute demande du "Newsletter" par e-mail, ou pour nous notifier des changements d'adresse, d'adresse e-mail, etc. vous pouvez me contacter à mfyates@gmail.com ou à paris@rblfrance.org ce dernier étant notre adresse officielle attachée à notre site web que vous pouvez consulter à http://www.rblfrance.org/

Vous trouverez ci-joint le formulaire d'adhésion à remplir et a renvoyer avec votre abonnement 2007-08.

A bientôt...

Mark Yates
Membership secretary

THE ROYAL BRITISH LEGION PARIS BRANCH

POPPY APPEAL ET COTISATIONS 2007/08
POPPY APPEAL & SUBSCRIPTIONS 2007/08

- Normal / *Normale* 46 Euros
- Reduced / *Réduite* (65 and + / *65 ans et* +) 37 Euros
- 25 years and under / *25 ans ou moins* 21 Euros

Poppy Appeal contribution
Contribution au "Poppy Appeal" .....

Annual subscription
Cotisation annuelle .....

Donation to the Administrative Fund
Don aux fonds administratifs .....

Donation to maintenance appeal
Don aux fonds de rénovation .....

TOTAL .....

Name / Nom .....

Address / Adresse .....

.....

e-mail ……..

Please tick the box below if you require a fiscal receipt and, if so, enclose a stamped addressed envelope.

Veuillez cocher la case si vous désirer un récépissé fiscal et, dans ce cas, joindre une enveloppe timbrée à votre attention.

☐

Please make your cheque payable to the "Royal British Legion".
Veuillez établir votre cheque à l'ordre de "Royal British Legion"

Royal British Legion. 8 rue Boudreau 75009 PARIS . Tel 01 47 42 19 26
Website : http://www.rblfrance.org/ e-mails : paris@rblfrance.org